



Packaging a File in InDesign Guide

Adobe InDesign is one of the most useful tools you will use as a designer. It is laid out very similar to the rest of the Adobe products but it will probably take you some time to get comfortable working in the program. InDesign doesn't embed media in the files you are working on so it is important that you learn how to package a file. When you package a file, it creates a folder with all the content and fonts used for the project.



HOW IT WORKS

InDesign does not import the materials you use when working on a project. It uses link to the file and displays a lower resolution thumbnail. This keeps the program from slowing down especially while you work on larger projects.

Since the program is using a pathway to the file you are using, if the file gets moved around the link will break. This also means when you send the InDesign file to someone else, they will not have the files that are linked to the project and an error will pop up when it's opened. It's the same problem for the fonts that are used in the project. If someone does not have the fonts already loaded on their computer, an error will pop up when the document is opened.

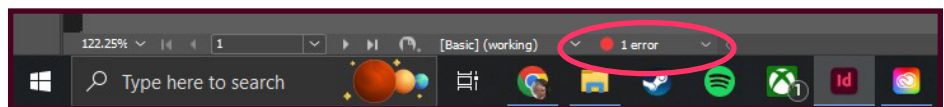
Packaging a document collects all the files needed for someone else to work on the project. It will put all the linked images and graphics into one folder called "Document Links" and the fonts used into a folder named "Document Fonts." It will also include a PDF of the project and a copy of the InDesign file.

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
Document fonts	9/29/2023 2:09 PM	File folder	
Links	9/29/2023 2:09 PM	File folder	
File Organization Guide	9/29/2023 2:09 PM	Chrome HTML Do...	245 KB
File Organization Resource	9/29/2023 2:09 PM	InDesign Markup ...	154 KB
File Organization Resource	9/29/2023 2:09 PM	InDesign Document	2,188 KB

PREFLIGHT

Before printing or handing off the document to someone else to work on, you can perform a quality check on the project file. Preflight is the industry-standard term for this process. While you edit your document, the Preflight panel warns of problems that can prevent a document from printing or outputting correctly.

The Preflight panel is located in the bottom left of InDesign. There will either be a green circle followed by "No errors" or a red circle and the number of document errors. Select the circle to open the Preflight panel. There are a few categories where errors are put into:



- **Links:** Determine whether missing links and modified links are displayed as errors.
- **Color:** Determine which images are set to the right color setting such as RGB for digital and CMYK for print.
- **Images and Objects:** Specify requirements for items such as image resolution, transparency, and stroke thickness.
- **Text:** The Text category displays errors for items such as missing fonts and over set text.
- **Document:** Specify requirements for page size and orientation, number of pages, blank pages, and bleed.

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PACKAGING

Once your document has gone through the Preflight check, you can package the file. Save the document and locate File > “Package...” in the top tool bar. The Package panel has a summary at the top which will be used the most.

“Fonts” will display how many fonts are used, if there are any missing fonts, and a few other options. The most important is that there are no missing fonts and that there are no protected fonts. You can view the problem fonts from the side menu.

“Links and Images” provides important information before outputting. Note that there is a warning symbol by this section. This is warning me that there are four links that use RGB color mode. If this document was intended for a client to print, I would want to make sure that these images are changed to CMYK before packaging. Because this document is not meant for printing, I can ignore this warning. You can view more details about the images from the side menu. This page will display the problem links names and locations so you can go back and resolve them.

Finally, select “Package...” at the bottom of the panel. This will bring up the final pop up. Navigate to the location for the packaged document to output and type in the name at the bottom. From here there are a few options to review and to make sure they are selected:

- “Copy Fonts...”
- “Copy Linked Graphics”
- “Update Graphic Links in Package”
- “Include PDF(Print)”

The other options are usually not usually necessary but I encourage you to read more. After you select “Package” at the bottom of the panel, you will have created a folder with everything needed to pass off the working file. Go back and look through the folders and see how they are organized.

